

Course Code	RSM219 H1 F
Course Name	Introduction to Financial Accounting
Term, Year	Fall, 2026
Course Meets	Please see the weekly schedule below. All sections are in-person. Additional information will be posted on the course Quercus page.
Web page URL	https://q.utoronto.ca
Course contact	RSM219@course.utoronto.ca and see Quercus page for details.

Weekly Lecture Schedule

Section	Day	Time	Instructor
LEC0101	Tuesday	9am – 11am	Dragan Stojanovic
LEC0201	Tuesday	11am – 1pm	Dragan Stojanovic
LEC0301	Tuesday	1pm – 3pm	Dragan Stojanovic
LEC0401	Wednesday	9am – 11am	Dragan Stojanovic
LEC0501	Thursday	9am – 11am	Catherine Barrette
LEC0601	Thursday	11am – 1pm	Catherine Barrette
LEC0701	Thursday	1pm – 3pm	Eszter Palancz
LEC0801	Thursday	3pm – 5pm	Catherine Barrette

Weekly Tutorial Schedule

Section	Day	Time	Tutorial leader (TA)
TUT0101	Friday	9am - 10am	Rachel Miao
TUT0201	Friday	11am - 12pm	Rachel Miao
TUT0301	Friday	12pm - 1pm	Alysa Nguyen
TUT0401	Friday	1pm – 2pm	Alysa Nguyen
TUT0501	Friday	2pm – 3pm	Rachel Miao
TUT0601	Friday	3pm – 4pm	Rachel Miao
TUT5101	Thursday	5pm - 6pm	Luca DiPietro
TUT5201	Thursday	6pm - 7pm	Luca DiPietro

Instructor Contact Information

Name	Email	Office Hours
Catherine Barrette	catherine.barrette@rotman.utoronto.ca	See Quercus
Dragan Stojanovic	dragan.stojanovic@rotman.utoronto.ca	See Quercus
Eszter Palancz	eszter.palancz@rotman.utoronto.ca	See Quercus

Course Description

Managers and executives across all industries use financial information to inform and evaluate their actions. Being a leader often means facing significant financial complexities and pressures. As a result, financial fluency and confidence are critical for effective leadership.

We will develop a framework for understanding and evaluating the financial health of organizations by using financial statements. We will connect this framework to other courses in the program. Our approach will be to “learn by doing” and we will analyze the financial statements of key global organizations.

Ultimately, this course will expand your leadership toolkit by developing your financial skills and confidence. It will empower you to understand and shape the narratives around financial information – helping you make better decisions and communicate more effectively.

Learning Outcomes

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

- ☐ Explain the importance of financial reporting and its relationship to other disciplines, including economics, finance, and strategy.
- ☐ Apply fundamental concepts and principles of financial reporting to analyze business transactions, events, and decisions.
- ☐ Interpret, analyze, and evaluate financial statements, including specific financial reporting issues relating to revenues, cash flows, current and operating assets, investments, liabilities, and shareholders' equity.
- ☐ Experiment with the financial statement analysis tools and techniques to make inferences about where the organization has been and where it is going.

Course Prerequisites

None.

Course Materials

Required Readings

- ☐ Wong, J., Hanlon, M., Magee, R., & Pfeiffer, G. (2023). *Financial accounting using IFRS* (3rd ed.). Cambridge Business Publishers. For purchase information, please see the Quercus page.

Electronic Course Materials

No additional electronic course materials are required.

Evaluation and Grades

Grades are a measure of the knowledge and skills developed by a student within individual courses. Each student will receive a grade on the basis of how well they have command of the course materials, skills and learning objectives of the course.

Work	Percentage of grade	Due Date
Planning for Success: Introduction and Goal-Setting Exercise	3%	Tuesday, September 22 by 5:00pm
Weekly Assignments	10% (best 8)	Ongoing, due Fridays by 5:00pm
Midterm Exam	25%	Tuesday, November 3 7:10pm – 9:00pm (110 minutes) Subject to change
Planning for Success: Reflection	2%	Friday, November 13 by 5:00pm
Group Assignment – Team Contract	3%	Thursday, October 22 by 5:00pm
Group Assignment – Team Mentor Check-In	2%	Friday, November 13 by 5:00pm
Group Assignment – Final Submission	15%	Friday, November 20 by 5:00pm
Final Exam	40%	During University Final Exam period (December 10 - 22, 2026)

Course Format and Expectations

Weekly assignments

Weekly assignments will be posted on the course Quercus page (with detailed instructions). While available weekly, only the best 8 of these individual assignments will count towards the final mark. The purpose of these assignments is to refine your ability to analyze financial reporting topics in a clear and concise manner. Individual weekly assignments may consist of multiple-choice questions and short-answer questions.

Group assignment

There will be one group assignment in this course, allowing you to develop your ability to productively work with others. You will be assigned to a group and are expected to fully participate and contribute to the final submission. For this assignment, you will analyze the financial statements of one or more companies. Details for the group assignment will be posted on the course Quercus page.

Midterm exam

Midterm Exam will be 110 minutes long, held in person, and will be cumulative (including classes 1-6). You will be allowed a hand-held calculator and one double-sided aid-sheet (8.5"x11"). Additional information will be posted on the course Quercus page.

Final exam

The final exam will be 180 minutes long and held during the University Final Exam period (details will be posted on the course Quercus page when available). You will be allowed a hand-held calculator and one double-sided aid-sheet (8.5"x11").

Communications in the course

Course-Related Questions and Clarifications

If you have questions about course content, such as lectures, tutorials, textbook material, assignments, or exams, please use the designated discussion boards. When posting, include specific details, such as textbook or workbook pages, or the assignment or exam you are referencing. Be sure to clearly explain your thought process and how you approached the problem. Including screenshots or other relevant details as needed will help instructors and peers provide accurate and helpful responses.

Personal Inquiries and Support

For personal questions, including issues related to accommodations or grades, please email RSM219@course.utoronto.ca. When reaching out, always include your full name, course section, student number, and any related details, such as screenshots, to ensure your request is handled promptly and accurately.

Technical Support

If you experience issues with the Quercus platform, contact q.help@utoronto.ca. For other technical problems, email help.desk@utoronto.ca for assistance. These teams can provide the support you need to resolve technical challenges.

Academic Support Resources

Rotman Commerce [Academic Support](#) offers services such as academic advising and academic skills coaching. The Centre for Professional Skills provides [writing and presentation coaching](#) to help you develop your academic and professional abilities. These resources are designed to support your success throughout your academic journey.

Contacting the Instructor

If you still need assistance after using the above resources, email your instructor directly. Include your full name, course section, student number, and all relevant details, such as screenshots. Providing complete information will help your instructor address your concerns efficiently.

Writing Assignments or Presentations

Assignments are intended to help you develop your communication skills. How well you communicate your ideas, in writing or orally, will be considered in the evaluation of the assignment. In your written assignments, you should aim for clarity, strong organization, concision, professionalism, and correct grammar. Your presentations should reflect strong planning and organization, clarity of speech, and an engaging demeanour. Sources, whether in written or presentation assignments, should always be correctly attributed.

Support is available through the RC Centre for Professional Skills (CPS) for students who would like help or feedback on their writing or speaking (presentations). CPS offers both individual and group appointments with trained writing instructors and presentation coaches who are familiar with the RC program and common types of business assignments. Coaches can also help you effectively work with generative AI in your work, where appropriate. You can also access your college Writing Centres for help with written assignments.

You can book an appointment [with a writing or presentation coach](#) through the RC Centre for Professional Skills Writing Centre. For more information about writing centres, student supports, and study resources, see the [Writing and Presentation Coaching academic support page](#).

Team or Group Assignments

Group assignments require students to work in teams of 5 students or less. Learning to work together in teams is a crucial transferrable skill you will use not only in your coursework, but also in your future careers. Support is available if you encounter common teamwork challenges such as:

- Team members feeling left out of the team.
- Team members not responding in a timely manner to communication.
- Division or quality of work among team members being unequal or unfair.

Consult the [Centre for Professional Skills Teamwork Resources page](#) for tips, strategies, and best practices. You can also [book an appointment with a teamwork mentor](#) through the RC Centre for Professional Skills Writing Centre or by emailing rotmancommerce.teamworkhelp@utoronto.ca. Teamwork mentors can help you resolve or mitigate conflicts, strategize on planning, or improve team communication.

If you are a student registered with Accessibility Services, and extensions are one of your academic accommodations, consult with your Accessibility Advisor about the teamwork in this course.

Rotman Commerce Attendance Policy

Rotman Commerce students are expected to make every effort to attend each class. Infrequently, students may miss term work, e.g., quizzes, assignments, etc., due to unplanned and extenuating circumstances and must follow the Request for Special Consideration process as outlined in their course outlines. However, Rotman Commerce will not approve any Request for Special Consideration for participation marks for missed classes. Any such request will be denied.

Missed Tests and Assignments

Students who miss a term test or assignment for reasons entirely beyond their control (e.g. illness) may request special consideration **within 2 business days** of the missed midterm/test/assignment due date.

In such cases, students must:

1. Complete the Request for Special Consideration form: <https://uoft.me/RSMConsideration>
2. Provide documentation to support the request, eg. Absence Declaration from [ACORN](#), [Verification of Illness Form](#) etc.

Please note: Students may use the Absence Declaration on ACORN ***one time per term*** to report an absence and request consideration. **Any subsequent absence will require a Verification of Illness form or other similar relevant documentation.**

Students who do not submit their requests and documentation within 2 days may receive a grade of 0 (zero) on the missed course deliverable.

Information about registering for an alternative time due to conflict will be announced on Quercus. Students who miss the midterm examination with appropriate documentation will have the midterm exam reweighted to the final exam. Students who are unable to complete required assignments and have submitted appropriate documentation (as described above) may have their marks reallocated to other deliverables at the discretion of the instructor.

Final Exams: If you miss the final exam in this course for a legitimate reason (illness, etc) you will need to contact your College Registrar to file a petition for a deferred exam. This deferred exam will be written at a later date as established by the Faculty of Arts & Science. Instructions can be found here: <https://www.artsci.utoronto.ca/current/faculty-registrar/petitions-appeals/preparing-petition>

Late Assignments

Late submissions will not be accepted and will receive a mark of zero, except for the final group assignment. Final group assignments that are submitted within 24 hours of the due date/time will receive a 10% penalty (deduction in assignment mark); group assignments that are submitted more than 24 hours after the due date/time will not be accepted and assignments will receive a mark of zero. Please note that weekly assignments will not be accepted after the submission deadline and will receive a mark of zero. Students who are unable to complete required assignments and have submitted appropriate documentation (as described above) may have their marks reallocated to other deliverables at the discretion of the instructor.

Statement on Equity, Diversity and Inclusion

The University of Toronto is committed to equity, human rights and respect for diversity. All members of the learning environment in this course should strive to create an atmosphere of mutual respect where all members of our community can express themselves, engage with each other, and respect one another's differences. U of T does not condone discrimination or harassment against any persons or communities.

Commitment to Accessibility

The University is committed to inclusivity and accessibility, and strives to provide support for, and facilitate the accommodation of, individuals with disabilities so that all may share the same level of access to opportunities and activities offered at the University.

If you require accommodations for a temporary or ongoing disability or health concern, or have any accessibility concerns about the course, the classroom or course materials, please [email Accessibility Services](#) or visit the [Accessibility Services website](#) for more information as soon as possible. Obtaining your accommodation letter may take up to several weeks, so get in touch with them as soon as possible. If you have general questions or concerns about the accessibility

of this course, you are encouraged to reach out to your instructor, course coordinator, or Accessibility Services.

Plagiarism Detection

Normally, students will be required to submit their course assignments to the University's plagiarism detection tool for a review of textual similarity and detection of possible plagiarism. In doing so, students will allow their assignments to be included as source documents in the tool's reference database, where they will be used solely for the purpose of detecting plagiarism. The terms that apply to the University's use of this tool are described on the [University's Plagiarism Detection Tool FAQ](#) page from Centre for Teaching Support & Innovation.

Generative AI / ChatGPT

In this course, you may use generative artificial intelligence (AI) tools, including ChatGPT, Microsoft Copilot, as learning aids. You will not be permitted to use generative AI on the midterm test or final exam. While some generative AI tools are currently available for free in Canada, please be warned that these tools have not been vetted by the University of Toronto and might not meet University guidelines or requirements for privacy, intellectual property, security, accessibility, and records retention. Generative AI may produce content which is incorrect or misleading, or inconsistent with the expectations of this course. These tools may be subject to service interruptions, software modifications, and pricing changes during the semester.

Generative AI is not required to complete any aspect of this course, and we caution you to not rely on these tools to complete your coursework. Instead, we recommend treating generative AI as a supplementary tool only for exploration. Ultimately, you (and not any AI tool) are responsible for your own learning in this course, and for all the work you submit for credit. It is your responsibility to critically evaluate the content generated, and to regularly assess your own learning independent of generative AI tools. Overreliance on generative AI may give you a false sense of how much you've actually learned, which can lead to poor performance on the midterm test or final exam, in later courses, or in future work or studies after graduation.

Academic Integrity

Academic Integrity is a fundamental value essential to the pursuit of learning and scholarship at the University of Toronto. Participating honestly, respectfully, responsibly, and fairly in this academic community ensures that the U of T degree that you earn will continue to be valued and respected as a true signifier of a student's individual work and academic achievement. As a result, the University treats cases of academic misconduct very seriously.

[The University of Toronto's Code of Behaviour on Academic Matters](#) outlines the behaviours that constitute academic misconduct, the process for addressing academic offences and the penalties that may be imposed. You are expected to be familiar with the contents of this document. Potential offences include, but are not limited to:

In papers and assignments

- Using someone else's ideas or words without appropriate acknowledgement.
- Submitting your own work in more than one course without the permission of the instructor.
- Making up sources or facts.
- Obtaining or providing unauthorized assistance on any assignment (this includes collaborating with others on assignments that are supposed to be completed individually).

On test and exams

- Using or possessing any unauthorized aid, including a cell phone.
- Looking at someone else's answers.
- Misrepresenting your identity.
- Submitting an altered test for re-grading.

Misrepresentation

- Falsifying institutional documents or grades.
- Falsifying or altering any documentation required by the University, including (but not limited to) medical notes.

All suspected cases of academic dishonesty will be investigated by the procedures outlined in the [Code of Behaviour on Academic Matters](#). If you have any questions about what is or is not permitted in the course, please do not hesitate to contact the course instructor. If you have any questions about appropriate research and citation methods, you are expected to seek out additional information from the instructor or other U of T or RC resources such as the RC Centre for Professional Skills, the College Writing Centres or the Academic Success Centre.

Email

At times, the course instructor may decide to communicate important course information by email. As such, all U of T students are required to have a valid UTmail+ email address. You are responsible for ensuring that your UTmail+ email address is set up and properly entered on ACORN. For more information visit the [Information Commons Help Desk](#).

Forwarding your utoronto.ca email to a Gmail or other type of email account is not advisable. In some cases, messages from utoronto.ca addresses sent to Gmail accounts are filtered as junk mail, which means that important messages from your course instructor may end up in your spam or junk mail folder.

Recording Lectures

Lectures and course materials prepared by the instructor are considered by the University to be an instructor's intellectual property covered by the Canadian Copyright Act. Students wishing to record a lecture or other course material in any way are required to ask the instructor's explicit permission and may not do so unless permission is granted. Students who have been previously granted permission to record lectures as an accommodation for a disability are excepted. This includes tape recording, filming, photographing PowerPoint slides, Quercus materials, etc.

To be clear, this prohibition includes, but is not limited to, recording by any means, including audio, video, and the use of artificial intelligence (AI) transcription or note-taking tools.

If permission for recording is granted by the instructor (or via Accessibility Services), it is intended for the individual student's own study purposes and does not include permission to "publish" them in any way. It is forbidden for a student to publish an instructor's notes to a website or sell them in any other form without formal permission.

Weekly Schedule

#	WEEK OF	TOPIC	READINGS	TUTORIAL DATES	WEEKLY ASSIGNMENTS
1	Sep. 7	Introducing financial accounting	Ch. 1: pp. 2-23 Ch. 12: pp. 545-550	Sep. 17-18	Open: Sep. 10 at 5:00pm Due: Sep. 18 at 5:00pm
2	Sep. 14	Conceptual framework of financial reporting	Ch. 1: pp. 17-26 Ch. 2: pp. 40-49 Ch. 12: pp. 545-550	Sep. 24-25	Open: Sep. 17 at 5:00pm Due: Sep. 25 at 5:00pm
PLANNING FOR SUCCESS: INTRODUCTION AND GOAL-SETTING EXERCISE (3%) Due Tuesday, September 22 nd at 5:00pm					
3	Sep. 21	Analysing transactions and events (1/2)	Ch. 2: pp. 38-57, 66-67	Oct. 1-2	Open: Sep. 24 at 5:00pm Due: Oct. 2 at 5:00pm
4	Sep. 28	Analysing transactions and events (2/2)	Ch. 3: pp. 94-114, 117-118	Oct. 8-9	Open: Oct. 1 at 5:00pm Due: Oct. 9 at 5:00pm
5	Oct. 5	Reporting and analysing cash flows	Ch. 11: pp. 482-507	Oct. 15-16	Open: Oct. 8 at 5:00pm Due: Oct. 16 at 5:00pm
6	Oct. 12	Analysing and interpreting financial statements	Ch. 12: pp. 542-565	Oct. 22-23	Open: Oct. 15 at 5:00pm Due: Oct. 23 at 5:00pm
7	Oct. 19	Reporting and analysing revenues and receivables	Ch. 4: pp. 150-172	Nov. 12-13	Open: Oct. 22 at 5:00pm Due: Nov. 6 at 5:00pm
GROUP ASSIGNMENT: Team Contract (3%) Due Thursday, Oct. 22 at 5:00pm					
Reading Week (NO CLASSES October 26-30, 2026)					
MIDTERM (25%, Tuesday, November 3rd, 7:10pm-9:00pm – subject to change) – No regular lectures or tutorials Nov. 2 - 6 Midterm details (including location) will be posted on the course Quercus page. Midterm covers classes 1-6.					
8	Nov. 9	Reporting and analysing inventories and current liabilities	Ch. 5: pp. 198-215 Ch. 7: pp. 278-284	Nov. 19-20	Open: Nov. 12 at 5:00pm Due: Nov. 20 at 5:00pm
GROUP ASSIGNMENT: Teamwork Mentors Check-In (2%) Due Friday, Nov. 13 at 5:00pm					
PLANNING FOR SUCCESS: REFLECTION (2%) Due Friday, Nov. 13 at 5:00pm					
9	Nov. 16	Reporting and analysing long-term operating assets	Ch. 6: pp. 236-257	Nov. 26-27	Open: Nov. 19 at 5:00pm Due: Nov. 27 at 5:00pm
GROUP ASSIGNMENT: Final Submission (15%) Due Friday, Nov. 20 at 5:00pm					
10	Nov. 23	Reporting and analysing financial investments	Ch. 10: pp. 420-442	Dec. 3-4	Open: Nov. 26 at 5:00pm Due: Dec. 4 at 5:00pm
11	Nov. 30	Reporting and analysing debt and equity Course review	Ch. 7: pp. 284-286, 299-302 Ch. 9: pp. 370-380, 382-387 Additional readings will be posted on Quercus	Self-study debriefing notes	No weekly assignment
FINAL EXAM (40%): during University Final Exam period (December 10 - 22, 2026)					

Please note that the last day you can drop this course without academic penalty is November 17, 2026.

Other Useful Links

- [Become a volunteer note taker](#)
- [Accessibility Services Note Taking Support](#)
- [Credit / No-Credit in RSM courses](#)
- [Rotman Commerce Academic Support](#)
- [Where to find teaching assistant opportunities](#)

URL links for print

- ACORN: <http://www.acorn.utoronto.ca/>
- Email Accessibility Services: accessibility.services@utoronto.ca
- Accessibility Services website: <http://studentlife.utoronto.ca/as>
- University's Plagiarism Detection Tool FAQ: <https://uoft.me/pdt-faq>
- The University of Toronto's Code of Behaviour on Academic Matters: <http://www.governingcouncil.utoronto.ca/policies/behaveac.htm>
- Information Commons Help Desk: <http://help.ic.utoronto.ca/category/3/utmail.html>
- Become a volunteer note taker: <https://studentlife.utoronto.ca/program/volunteer-note-taking/>
- Accessibility Services Note Taking Support: <https://studentlife.utoronto.ca/service/note-taking-support/>
- Credit / No-Credit in RSM courses: <https://rotmancommerce.utoronto.ca/current-students/degree-requirements/credit-no-credit-option/>
- Rotman Commerce Academic Support: <https://rotmancommerce.utoronto.ca/current-students/academic-support/>
- Book an appointment with a writing or presentation coach: <http://uoft.me/writingcentres>
- Writing and Presentation Coaching academic support page: <https://rotmancommerce.utoronto.ca/current-students/academic-support/writing-and-presentation-coaching/>
- Centre for Professional Skills Teamwork Resources page: <https://rotmancommerce.utoronto.ca/teamwork-resources>
- Book an appointment with a Teamwork Mentor: <http://uoft.me/writingcentres>